

The Software

Discreet Lustre

Discreet Lustre system software is Autodesk Media and Entertainment's award-winning high-performance DI system for colour grading and look creation. The design of the software is such that it delivers real-time primary and secondary colour correction and grading capabilities, while providing a sophisticated feature set for working with high-resolution imagery and digital intermediates. It has come to be regarded as the industry standard today.

Discreet Smoke

Discreet Smoke is an all-in-one integrated creative editing and finishing system.

Autodesk Combustion

Autodesk Combustion 4 is an all-in-one professional compositing application designed to meet the needs of the world's

most demanding artists. It features non-destructive workflow, an extensive toolset, and the kind of power professionals demand.

Discreet Flint

Flint lets you design stunning graphics with speed and interactivity. It provides instant feedback for complex compositing, paint, motion-graphics animation and visual effects. It also lets you work with high-quality RGB images with real-time video I/O.

Discreet Inferno

Inferno provides the instantaneous feedback required for fully-interactive online experimentation and rapid turnaround. Now architected for 64-bit performance, Inferno provides the best real-time performance for high-definition post-production, from 4K feature film and digital cinema to HDTV and video.

Discreet Flame

A powerful 3D compositing environment, this delivers amazing creative results using industry-leading tools specifically designed for high-definition, multi-format post-production—from video and HDTV to 2K digital cinema. Flame tools include Action (a 3D visual effects design environment), 3D tracking, Motion Estimation, and the powerful Colour Warper and Modular Keyer features.

Discreet Fire

This is a premier online editing and finishing system designed for 2K/4K digital intermediate, HDTV, and video post-production. It lets you interactively manipulate up to 30 layers of high-resolution film in its advanced 3D DVE (Digital Virtual Environment) and compositing environment.

Hollywood To Bollywood

It took over a decade for post-production and special effects technologies to cover the distance between the western coasts of the US and India. And during this time, the technology leapfrogged. "We in India will catch up, though. We are always playing the same game even when it concerns other technologies or aspects of technology. It will not be too different here either," says Kedia.

Acceptance of the technology was not overnight in the US either, says Cooney. "There were doubts about the abilities of these software and technologies and then, of course, there were the sceptics. But eventually, when the first big hit that used technology extensively was delivered, everyone wanted to do it," she says.

Precisely what Khandpur thinks is required for the Indian film industry to completely realise the potential of these software. "One big hit and the whole industry will be making special effects oriented movies," he assures. But for now, it's mostly clean-ups and corrections. "When directors come to us today, what they are looking for is to mainly clean up some grey areas. But once

we show them what is possible, they realise their mistake of not having involved us earlier. It's a one-time thing we have to do with all directors, but it's starting to pay off," says Khandpur.

The Professionals

What directors lack today is the presence of VFX supervisors on the sets. "It's important to get the logic right when planning or executing effects. Unfortunately, the concept of a VFX supervisor is absent in India. There is activity, though, to create such specialists," says Namit Malhotra, managing director of Prime Focus.

While filmmakers struggle to come to terms with the possibilities before them, those behind the scenes making things happen are already having to grapple with problems of their own. "DI and VFX are two totally different aspects. To get into either, though, you need knowledge of editing," says Cooney.

There seems to be an abundance of editors willing to learn the tricks of the trade, but there hasn't always been a place they could go to learn it from. So most end up learning on the job. "It's a good thing and a bad thing too... while the new

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